

Principles and criteria for selecting corpus material

Principles

These principles are adjusted from Sinclair. 2005. "Corpus and Text: Basic Principles." In Developing Linguistic Corpora: A Guide to Good Practice, edited by Martin Wynne. AHDS Guides to Good Practice. Oxbow Books.

1. The internal content of the sermons is not relevant to their inclusion. Accordingly, the sermons are selected exclusively based on the criteria outlined below.
2. The corpus is designed as a contrastive corpus. As a historical corpus, it deliberately seeks internal contrast; however, only those components that were originally intended to be contrasted are included.
3. No textual material preceding or following the sermon itself is permitted - this includes metadata from the corpus compiler as well as liturgical or lexical remarks by the original author.
4. The corpus includes only complete sermons; consequently, text lengths vary substantially.
5. The corpus aims to be as representative as possible of written and published sermons within the criteria defined below. It does not, however, claim representativeness for orally delivered sermons or for texts that fall outside these criteria.
6. The corpus should include as many sermons as possible.

Criteria

1. The corpus consists of self-identified sermons (mode of the text)
2. The corpus consists of written and published sermons (type of text)
3. The corpus consists of sermons held in the context of the Evangelical-Lutheran Church in Denmark (domain and location of the text).
 - a. i.e. the sermons can be...
 - i. Written versions of sermons given at an actual church service
 - ii. Written sermons from preachers affiliated with the Evangelical-Lutheran Church in Denmark
4. The corpus consists of sermons written in Danish (the language of the text)
5. The corpus consists only of sermons related to holidays in the liturgical calendar of the Evangelical-Lutheran Church in Denmark.
6. The corpus consists of sermons published within the given time period: April 1940 - May 1945 (The Occupation)